American Postal Workers Union
AFL-CIO

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LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT



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Introduction



What makes an effective leader? What sets him/her apart from other people? Is it his/her educational background, financial status, age, race, sex, or occupation? No, it's his/her awareness of the challenges he/she faces, and the enthusiasm for creating new opportunities. It's his/her desire to step up and make a difference. To be an effective leader, requires one not only to lead, but to also be a team player. Both teamwork and leadership are essential to a union's success, as valuable feedback from team members help the leader make sound decisions.

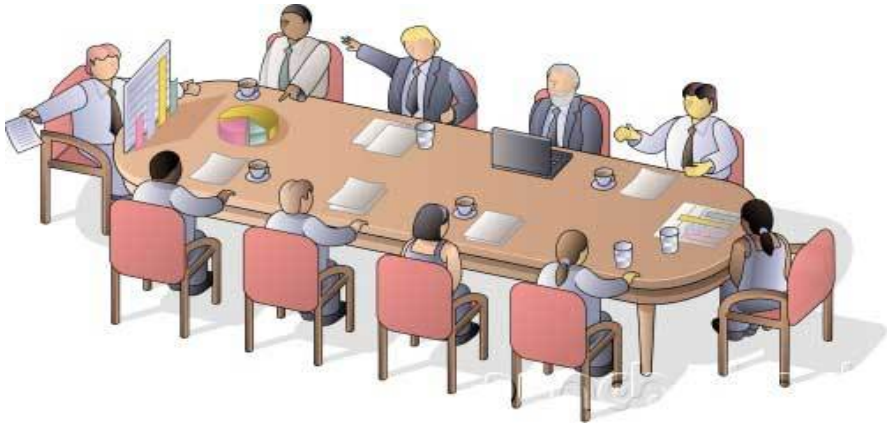
The practice and spirit of democracy in the union movement depends, at least in part, on the knowledge, imagination, and hard work of local and state union leaders. This handbook is designed to assist APWU leaders in acquiring the knowledge and skills needed to run an effective union to meet the upcoming struggles and challenges of the future. It helps union leaders understand the responsibilities, challenges, and qualities of leadership; examines goal setting; outlines the steps to developing effective listening skills; defines diversity and its importance in the labor movement, and gives tips on stress reduction.

Also, it offers a basic knowledge of democratic meeting procedures, gives tips on how to get along with difficult people and resolve conflict, and explains union officers' responsibilities under the Office of Labor-Management Standards (OLMS) of the U.S. Department of Labor. This handbook explains the importance of recruiting volunteers and reaching out to younger union members to aid in the union's struggle to preserve postal jobs and benefits and to help strengthen the labor movement and the rights of working people.

If we can better reach our union members and inspire them to become more involved in our fight to bring a voice to workers in every workplace, we will not only reap the benefits in our own movement, we will also increase the knowledge of democratic participation that our members and leaders will carry over into other organizations in the community to which they belong.

Special Note: ***Resource material utilized for this Leadership Development handbook is from: APWU Executive Officer's Training, The APWU Website, Wayne State University APWU Leadership Training, and numerous publications from the AFL-CIO.***

Duties and Responsibilities of APWU National Officers and Departments



The duties and responsibilities of local and state officers are normally outlined in the local's and state's constitution and bylaws. In most cases, local and state officers have a counterpart at the national level available to offer assistance and support.

The American Postal Workers Union's (APWU), highest governing body is its biennial national convention. Between conventions, a 13-person National Executive board sets union policy. Members of the NEB include the President; Executive Vice President; Secretary-Treasurer; Director of Industrial Relations; the directors of the Clerk, Maintenance, Motor Vehicle, and Support Services Divisions, and five Regional Coordinators. The union's national officers are elected by the membership every three years through a mail ballot referendum. The national officers' duties and responsibilities as outlined in APWU's Constitution and Bylaws, include:

President - "It shall be the duty of the President to preside at all conventions and at meetings of the National Executive Board and National Executive Council. The President shall be a member of all committees and shall appoint the necessary committees at each convention. Subject to the President's authority under Article 21, he or she shall fill all vacancies from any cause whatsoever, subject to approval by a majority of the members of the National Executive Board, or shall combine the duties of a vacant position when they can be absorbed by other officers, subject to the approval of two thirds (2/3) of the National Executive Council. If a vacant position is not abolished at the next National Convention by the delegates, the position will be placed on the ballot for the next election following the convention."

"The President shall be empowered to appoint the necessary staff at national headquarters and throughout the organization to carry on the necessary programs of the Union such as industrial engineers, economists, financial technicians, industrial relations technicians, public relations personnel and national organizers; submit to each convention a written report of official acts during his or her term of office; sign all orders drawn by the Secretary-Treasurer and countersign all checks; be responsible for all work of the Union and all officers of the Union shall work under his or her supervision and be the Editor of the official publication of the Union."

Executive Vice President - "The Executive Vice President shall perform the duties of the President in case of the President's absence or inability to attend to the duties of office. In the event of death or resignation of the President, the Executive Vice President shall replace him or her until the next national election; be a member of the National Negotiations Committee; under the direction of the President assist in handling Union business and in the absence of the President is authorized to sign checks."

Secretary-Treasurer - "The Secretary- Treasurer, under the supervision of the President shall keep a record of all proceedings and all other records of this Union; be the custodian of the official seal and shall issue all charters; supervise the recording of the membership of each local union, along with the name and address of each member-at-large; see that a written report is submitted to the National Convention, showing the number of locals and members and a written report of all official acts during his or her term of office; receive and deposit all monies from all local unions and members at-large; be the official custodian of all monies of this Union; disburse all monies by check countersigned by the President and see that a written report is submitted to the National Convention of all monies received and disbursed."

"The Secretary-Treasurer shall submit the books of the organization to an attested public accountant at the close of each fiscal year and a report of the accounting shall be verified by the Finance Committee. Upon written request, the report of the accounting shall be sent to local presidents, along with the Secretary-Treasurer's analysis of the Union's financial position. He or she shall perform other duties as required by the President."

Industrial Relations Department - "The Industrial Relations Director shall be responsible for labor-management, national negotiations, mechanization, health and safety for all divisions of the Union and the administration of the contract."

Legislative and Political Department - "The Legislative/Political Director shall be responsible for directing all activities of the Union with regard to legislation of interest to the members and their families; to develop publicity programs; be the Editor of the news bulletin and the Associate Editor of the official publication of the Union; work in cooperation with the AFL-CIO and other national and international unions with regard to legislation and assist the President in the distribution of COPA (Committee on Political Action) funds."

Organization Department - "The Organization Director shall direct and be responsible for maintaining and increasing the membership in this Union; direct the organization of the unorganized; promote, encourage and advise membership committees in all phases of membership recruitment programs; prepare and maintain organizing material that appeals to respective membership of all divisions under jurisdiction of the APWU."

Research and Education Department - "The Research and Education Director shall be responsible for conducting research and administering educational programs at the national, regional, state, area and local levels. Education shall be a mandatory part of the business of the APWU, particularly education in labor history, labor problems, grievance procedure, the objectives and problems of the APWU, its members and their families."

APWU Health Plan - "The APWU shall have a Health Plan Director. This officer shall serve on the Board of Directors for the APWU Health Plan and shall work under the direction of the President." Contact the Health Plan at: ***1 (410) 424-1500***.

Human Relations Department - "The Human Relations Director shall prepare and direct programs in the area of equal opportunity, civic, community service, and all other related programs. The President reserves the right to appoint representative(s) with the recommendation of the Human Relations Director to handle OWCP and EEO cases, on an "as needed basis, to work under the direction of the Human Relations Director. Such representatives will be reimbursed for expenses and lost time only."

Regional Coordinators - "There shall be five (5) Regional Coordinators elected from their respective regions. The Regional Coordinators shall operate under the direction of the president."

Caribbean Area National Business Agent - "There shall be an elected National Business Agent who shall serve all APWU-represented employees in all divisions for the Caribbean Area and shall be eligible to participate as a National Business Agent in all official meetings of the Division Councils, excluding the filling of vacancies in Article 18."

Alaskan Area National Business Agent - "There shall be an elected National Business Agent who shall serve all APWU-represented employees in all divisions within the state of Alaska on an "as needed" basis and shall be eligible to participate as a National Business Agent in all official meetings of the Division Councils, excluding the filling of vacancies in Article 18."

Pacific Area National Business Agent - "There shall be an elected National Business Agent who shall serve all APWU-represented employees in all divisions within the Pacific Area and shall be eligible to participate as a National Business Agent in all official meetings of the Division Councils, excluding the filling of vacancies in Article 18."

Retirees Department - "The Retirees Department Director shall be responsible for directing the objectives of the department; legislative and political activity; administering retirement educational programs; organizing new members of the Retirees Department and Local and State Retiree Chapters; service the needs of retired members and their survivors and such other duties as assigned by the President."

Clerk Division Director - "The Director shall be responsible for the Division; for processing all grievances in the Division; be a member of the Labor-Management Committee and National Negotiations Committee; chair a Clerk Division Council meeting to be held in conjunction with the National Convention and All-Craft Conference. The National Clerk Division Council shall be comprised of the Division Director, the two (2) Assistant Directors and the National Business Agents."

Clerk Division Assistant Directors (A) and (B) - "Assistant Directors (A) and (B) shall assist the Director of the Clerk Division in handling grievances and such other duties that may be assigned."

Clerk Division National Business Agents - "The thirty-seven (37) National Business Agents shall serve as field representatives in their assigned regions or in any place that the President so directs. Under the Division Director's supervision, they shall have jurisdiction over grievances and organization matters within their assigned region."

Motor Vehicle Service Division (MVS) Director - "The Director shall be responsible for handling all problems and grievances pertaining to MVS; be a member of the Labor-Management Committee and National Negotiations Committee; chair a Motor Vehicle Service Division Council meeting to be held in conjunction with the National Convention and All-Craft Conference. The National Motor Vehicle Service Division Council shall be comprised of the Division Director, Assistant Director and National Business Agents."

Motor Vehicle Service Division (MVS) Assistant Director - "The Assistant Director shall be responsible for maintaining all records of the MVS membership and assisting the Director of the MVS Division in grievances and other organizational problems."

Motor Vehicle Service Division (MVS) National Business Agents - "There shall be six (6) National Business Agents. They shall be responsible for handling problems; grievances and such other duties as may be assigned to them by the Director of the MVS Division."

Maintenance Division Director - "The Director shall be responsible for the Division and have authority concerning Maintenance employees; be a member of the National Negotiations Committee, National Mechanization Committee and Labor-Management Committee; chair a Maintenance Division Council meeting to be held in conjunction with the National Convention and All-Craft Conference. The National Maintenance Division Council shall be comprised of the Division Director, Assistant Directors and National Business Agents."

Maintenance Division Assistant Director (A) - "Assistant Director (A) shall assist the Director of the Maintenance Division in the handling of grievances and such other duties that may be assigned and also assume the duties of the BMC Coordinator, to include: (1) directing inquiries or special problems at the Bulk Mail Centers (BMC) to the national officers for resolution and/ or immediate response; (2) coordinating and co-chairing the BMC meetings with the host local; and (3) provide written response to specific problems within sixty (60) days."

Maintenance Division Assistant Director (B) - "Assistant Director (B) shall assist the Director of the Maintenance Division in the handling of grievances and such other duties that may be assigned."

Maintenance Division National Business Agents - "There shall be nine (9) National Business Agents of the Maintenance Division. They shall be responsible for handling problems; grievances and such other duties as may be assigned to them by the Director of the Maintenance Division."

Support Services Division Director - "The Director shall be responsible for grievances; organization matters and other issues relating to the Division; be a member of the Labor Management Committee and the National Negotiations Committee."

"The Division shall be comprised of members from Information Service Centers, Mail Transport Equipment Service Centers, Mail Equipment Shops, Material Distribution Centers, Operating Service Facilities, Mail Transport Operations, Postal Medical Units, other non-mail processing facilities or operations and related operations in the private sector with the right to ratify respective agreements."

Support Services Division National Business Agent - "The National Business Agent position shall serve as field representative under the Division Director's supervision and shall be responsible for handling problems, grievances and such other duties as may be assigned to them by the Director of the Support Services Division."

For additional information, contact APWU resident officers and departments at 1 (202) 842-4200.

A Compliance Guide for New Union Officers



The Office of Labor-Management Standards (OLMS) of the U.S. Department of Labor has prepared a guide to help union officers properly carry out some of their duties. OLMS enforces certain provisions of the Labor-Management Reporting and Disclosure Act (LMRDA), which guarantees rights to union members and imposes responsibilities on union officers. The LMRDA establishes a bill of rights for union members; reporting requirements for unions, union officers, and union employees; standards for the election of union officers, and safeguards for protecting union funds and assets.

This guide includes general information regarding LMRDA requirements that apply to unions and union officers and offers suggestions on how to comply with these requirements. Although this guide is designed primarily for newly elected presidents and financial officers, it should be helpful to all new officers.

Unions Must File Annual Financial Reports



The LMRDA requires unions to file financial reports annually with OLMS. Unions with annual receipts of $250,000 or more (and those under trusteeship) must file Form LM-2. Unions with annual receipts less than $250,000 may file the shorter Form LM-3, and unions with annual receipts less than $10,000 may file Form LM-4. Annual financial reports must be signed by the president and treasurer or corresponding principal officers and are due within 90 days after the end of your union's fiscal year. Unions can now complete the Form LM-2, LM-3, or LM-4 quickly and easily by using the new web-based Electronic Forms System (EFS), which is available at ***www.olms.dol.gov***.

- ☐ Unions must make annual financial reports available to their members and permit members to examine supporting records. The reports and documents filed with OLMS are public information and any person may examine them or obtain copies from the OLMS National Office. Anyone with a computer and Internet connection can examine reports or obtain copies through the OLMS Internet Public Disclosure Room at ***www.unionreports.dol.gov***.

Suggestions

- ☐ When taking office, ensure that the union is up-to-date in filing Form LM-2, LM-3, or LM-4 annual financial reports, and that a copy of the last report is in the union's files. If the union is not up-to-date in filing its annual financial report, file the required report immediately. Notify OLMS if the union changes its address.

- ☐ When completing the annual financial report, gather records well before the due date and review the instructions thoroughly to make sure that the report is completed properly. If you have any questions, call OLMS at **(202) 693-0123.**

- ☐ If the union amends its constitution and bylaws, remember to submit a dated copy as an electronic attachment to the union's next annual financial report. Check the union's constitution and bylaws to review any other requirements regarding financial reporting. Also, contact former local/state officers and the APWU Secretary-Treasurer at 1300 L, Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20005 to determine if the local/state union is required to file reports with the IRS.

Unions Must Maintain Certain Records



The LMRDA requires unions to maintain the records necessary to verify the reports filed with OLMS for at least five years after the reports are filed. As a general rule, all types of records used in the normal course of doing business must be maintained such as receipts and disbursements journals, cancelled checks, bank records, dues collection receipts, vendor receipts, credit card slips, and meeting minutes, etc.

- ☐ All election records must be maintained for one year after the election. If the union has an established paper or electronic record keeping system, review it thoroughly and, if necessary, check with prior officers on how records are maintained. Become familiar with the types of records the union maintains, including those needed to complete annual financial reports.

Unions Must Safeguard Funds and Assets



The LMRDA imposes a duty on union officers to manage the funds and property of the union solely for the benefit of the union in accordance with its constitution and bylaws.

- ☐ A union officer or employee who embezzles union funds or other assets commits a federal crime punishable by a fine and/or imprisonment. Individuals who have been convicted of certain crimes listed in the LMRDA may not hold union office or employment for up to 13 years after their conviction or the end of their imprisonment, if any.

- ☐ Use a system of checks and balances to ensure that one person is not solely responsible for all financial transactions. For example, require that two officers sign all checks. ***Do not sign blank checks. Ensure that the date, payee, and amount are entered.***

- ☐ Review current practices for collecting dues and other receipts to ensure that all receipts are recorded in union books and records, member dues are deposited in the bank on a timely basis, and deposits are properly recorded.

- ☐ Confirm that all expenditures are authorized in accordance with the union's constitution and bylaws and are properly recorded in membership/executive board minutes and union disbursement books and records.

- ☐ Remove any former officers' names from union bank accounts.

- ☐ Conduct an inventory of union assets to determine if they match prior inventory and union records of purchases and sales.

- ☐ Have trustees or an audit committee conduct periodic audits and report to the membership. The OLMS publication, **Conducting Audits in Small Unions: A Guide for Trustees**, is available from the nearest OLMS field office.

- ☐ If you discover a possible misuse of union funds, contact the national APWU Union or OLMS.

Union Officers and Employees Must Be Bonded



The LMRDA requires officers and employees of unions with property and annual receipts of more than $5,000 to be bonded if they handle union funds or property. Handling funds is not limited to physical contact with money. For example, a person who has the authority to sign checks or redeem certificates of deposit is considered to be handling funds.

- ☐ The minimum bonding amount for each covered officer or employee is 10 percent of the funds handled by the official and his/her predecessor, if any, during the preceding fiscal year. For a new local/state union, the bond must be at least $1,000.

- ☐ Bonding coverage required by the LMRDA is limited to protection against financial loss arising from fraudulent or dishonest acts, including larceny, theft, and embezzlement. The required bond must be obtained from a company on the U.S. Treasury Department list of approved bonding companies. The bond may not have a deductible since that is a form of prohibited self-insurance.

Suggestions

- ☐ Officer of a newly formed local/state union should contact APWU's Secretary-Treasurer's office at 1300 L. Street NW, Washington, DC 20005 to obtain information on adequate bonding coverage.

- ☐ Officer of an established union should contact APWU's Secretary-Treasurer's office at 1300 L. Street NW, Washington, DC 20005 to determine if the amount of the union's bond is adequate. If not, increase coverage immediately. Ensure that the union's bond covers losses due to fraud or theft by each bonded individual.

Unions Must Conduct Fair Elections of Officers



Local unions must elect their officers by secret ballot at least every three years. Officer elections must be conducted in accordance with the provisions of the union's constitution and bylaws as long as they comply with the LMRDA.

- ☐ Every member in good standing has the right to nominate candidates, to be a candidate subject to reasonable qualifications uniformly imposed, and to support and vote for the candidates of the member's choice.

- ☐ Unions must mail a notice of election to every member at the member's last known home address at least 15 days prior to the election.

- ☐ Neither the Union nor the USPS assets, including funds, equipment, and property, may not be used to promote the candidacy of any candidate. However, union funds may be used for reasonable expenses necessary to run an election.

- ☐ ***Employees cannot campaign while on the Postal Service's time clock***.

Suggestions

- ☐ Review the union's constitution and bylaws well ahead of the scheduled election and determine the time frames for conducting all aspects of nominations and the election.

- ☐ Update the union's membership mailing list regularly. For guidance on doing this, see the OLMS publication **Updating Your Union's Membership Mailing List**.

- ☐ Request a copy of **Conducting Local Union Officer Elections: A Guide for Election Officials** from the nearest OLMS field office for use by those who will be conducting the upcoming election.

Unions Must Allow Members to Exercise Their LMRDA Rights



Union members have safeguards against improper discipline, equal rights to participate in union activities, freedom of speech and assembly with other members, and safeguards against improper dues increases.

- ☐ Union members and non-member employees have the right to receive or inspect copies of collective bargaining agreements. It is unlawful to use force or violence against union members who are exercising their rights under the LMRDA.

- ☐ For additional information call the DOL Help Line at 1-866-487-2365.

SPECIAL NOTE: ***The text in this section was taken from LMRDA Compliance: A Guide for New Union Officers Fact Sheet.***

For additional information on conducting local/state elections contact Annette August-Taylor, Executive Assistant to the Secretary-Treasurer, at aaugust@apwu.org.

Responsibilities and Challenges of Leadership



An effective leader must be able to influence and inspire other people. He/she must be a visionary and must lead by example with a clear goal in mind. An effective leader possesses many qualities that set him/her apart from the crowd and faces many challenges; he/she must be able to rise to the occasion. Challenges include:

- ☐ **Accepting Criticism** - No person in a position of authority will be immune from it. One must learn to sort out the constructive, from which one can learn, and the malicious, which one must ignore.
- ☐ **Withstanding Adversity** - Things will not always go well; failures will happen. A good leader will bounce back.
- ☐ **Delegating Authority** - Making assignments and following up on the results.
- ☐ **Speaking Before a Crowd** - Talking to reporters during pickets or demonstrations.
- ☐ **Chairing Meetings** - Serving as the chairperson during union and executive board meetings.
- ☐ **Standing up to People in Powerful Positions** - Not afraid to file a grievance when the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) or employee's rights are violated.
- ☐ **Always Doing What's Best for the Organization** - Never allowing his/her personal feelings to interfere with what's best for the union.
- ☐ **Sharing the Credit** - Learning to praise others and to give credit where it's due.
- ☐ **Concentrating During Stressful Times** - Able to concentrate under difficult circumstances, always keeping the union's goal in mind.
- ☐ **Accepting Responsibility for Mistakes** - Assuming responsibility for his/her mistakes and the mistakes of others.

Qualities of Effective Leaders



Effective leadership is about recognizing and taking advantage of the skills and talents from different people to form a productive and efficient organization. Effective leadership requires essential qualities. He/she must be:

- ☐ **Honest** - Is clear on what his/her values are and are consistent in applying them. Does the honest thing and never allows personal feelings to cloud his/her judgement.

- ☐ **Confident** - Knows where he/she is going, have outlined specific and obtainable goals for the organization, and stay the course.

- ☐ **Respectful** - Treats all people in the organization with dignity and respect.

- ☐ **A Motivator** - Possess the confidence to make decisions and instills confidence in others.

- ☐ **Compassionate** - Cares not only about the organization, but about the people in it and demonstrates that he/she cares through his/her words and actions.

- ☐ **A Visionary** - Is action orientated and understands what is needed and how to achieve it. Solicits input from those around him/her so that everyone feels that his/her opinion is important.

- ☐ **Knowledgeable and Humble** - Knows the various resources available to union members and keeps abreast of current issues confronting the union, but doesn't try to do everything or claim to know everything.

- ☐ **Levelheaded** - Doesn't lose his/her cool under pressure. Rather than panic, he/she works harder and is not afraid to take risks or make mistakes.

- ☐ **Self-Aware** - Knows his/her own strengths and weaknesses and how to best utilize the strengths of others for the good of the organization.

- ☐ **Committed** - Leads by example and works alongside everyone else, showing that the organization is more successful when everyone works together.

Efficient Time Management Skills



Wikipedia defines time management as the act or process of planning and exercising conscious control over the amount of time spent on specific activities, especially to increase effectiveness, efficiency or productivity. When you learn to take control of your time, you improve your ability to focus and finish tasks more quickly and efficiently. The following steps will aide you in efficient time management:

- ☐ **Determine Your Most Creative Time of Day** - Mark that time in your calendar as if it was an important scheduled meeting.

- ☐ **Keep Your Calendar on Your Desk** - Check the calendar every day to see which items need attention.

- ☐ **When Recording an Appointment** - Record the address, telephone number, and directions at the same time.

- ☐ **Avoid Scheduling Every Minute of Your Day** - Allow time to accommodate interruptions.

- ☐ **Create a "To Do" List and a Filing System** - Write the list early each morning, or the night before. Use folders for keeping track of materials for later follow up, e.g. meeting material, returning phone calls, letters needing a response, and items to refer to someone else, etc. Mark one folder as "**Urgent"** and work on those items first.

- ☐ **Keep Track of Your Messages** - Use a duplicate message pad to maintain a permanent record of names, telephone numbers, and dates of calls.

- ☐ **Return Telephone Calls** - Return phone calls in the order of importance. List the points you want to cover so you won't forget anything and waste time calling back.

Weekly Plan

Objectives: What I hope to accomplish by the end of the week.

Activities Required to Accomplish Objectives	Priority	Which Day	Time Needed

Setting Priorities



Setting priorities is the most important step to aid in stress reduction. It enables you to utilize time wisely. In setting priorities, allow for unanticipated events and activities beyond your control and:

- ☐ **Enjoy a Good Breakfast** - This enables you to have a positive attitude to start the day.
- ☐ **Set Deadlines and Avoid Over-Scheduling** - This will enable you to get things done.
- ☐ **Plan the Most Challenging Activities** - Conduct those activities at the time of day when you are most creative and energetic.
- ☐ **Carry a Pocket Notebook** - Jot down notes, keep a list of items, and cross out items as they are completed.
- ☐ **Don't Put off until Tomorrow** - Take care of problems as they arise.
- ☐ **Delegate** - Assign tasks to individuals who are willing to help.
- ☐ **Recognize Your Limits** - Choose what is most urgent and set aside other problems until later.
- ☐ **One Thing at a Time** - Trying to do many activities at once ruins your concentration and leads to more stress.
- ☐ **Slow down** - If you work too fast, you make mistakes.
- ☐ **Don't be a Workaholic** - Find a health balance between work and play.
- ☐ **Go to Bed Early and Arise Early** - Avoid sleeping too late and rushing to work or appointments.

Setting Goals



A goal is a specific, measurable statement of what we want to accomplish by a given point in time. One of the most common mistakes made by leaders is the failure to set goals and objectives for the organization they represent. Goal setting is important because it helps the union to determine where the organization is heading and measures the accomplishments being made.

A well-formulated goal should be **SMART:**

- **S**pecific - specifies the result or outcome to be achieved,
- **M**easurable - helps you measure your progress,
- **A**ttainable - specifies how it would be achieved,
- **R**ealistic - don't set goals so high that they are unattainable, and
- **T**ime Based - specifies a time frame for the goal to be achieved.

Fact: The Sunrise Local has over 500 employees who are eligible to belong to the APWU. However, only 70% belong (350).

Broad Goal Example: It is the local's goal to increase the membership to 75%.

SMART Goal Example: The union will sign up 25 new members by the November meeting.

SMART Goals Identify How to Achieve the Goal

Officers and stewards will ask all union members to wear their union t-shirts to work every Thursday. The shop stewards, wearing their union t-shirts, will serve free coffee and donuts in the break room to members and non-members. A display of union buttons and literature will be on the tables and the shop steward will explain the importance of belonging to the union. Those non-members signing up, will receive a free union t-shirt.

The Importance of Utilizing Committees



As often as possible, the president should utilize the creative resources of committee members. This will allow the leader more time for thinking, planning, coordinating, and running the organization. Good committee work requires clear assignments, regular meetings, and periodic review of results. Tips on maintaining active committees include:

- ☐ **Keep Records** - Maintain a list of committee members, with names, up-to-date addresses, and phone numbers. Keep minutes or notes of jobs to do and decisions made. Keep a list of each person's assignments, skills, and "strong suits."

- ☐ **Call Meetings Regularly** - Do not just keep in touch with each person separately. People need to see and feel that they are part of something big.

- ☐ **Contact Committee Members Before Meetings** - To make sure they will attend, and know that their attendance is important.

- ☐ **Give All Committee Members a Copy of Minutes** - About what was decided at the meeting to remind them of their duties.

- ☐ **Allow Committee Members to Make Decisions** - Let committee members decide what jobs to do, how they can best be done, and who can do them best. They will work harder for things they decide themselves.

- ☐ **Set Goals for Each Activity** - Set high standards; achieving them will give committee members a feeling of accomplishment. And remember, you won't get more than you ask for.

- ☐ **Reward Committee Members** - Thank committee members and give credit when a job is done well. Give each member a small token of appreciation.

Standing and Special Committees



Special Committees are appointed by the president to handle specific tasks, such as: organizing picnics, voter registration drives, and/or researching the cost of attending union educational conferences, and conventions. Standing Committees duties are normally outlined in the constitution and bylaws, and other types of committees include:

- ☐ **Education Committee** - Conducts educational workshops and programs. The committee should keep abreast of the various handbooks and manuals available for purchase through the APWU Order Department and should advertise classes offered through the labor institutes, and the APWU at the national and state levels.

- ☐ **Human Relations Committee** - Is responsible for working with community civic organizations and keeping the members informed of the various resources available. The committee should assist APWU members with questions on Civil Rights Issues, Veterans Administration, Credit Counseling, and provide Referral Services.

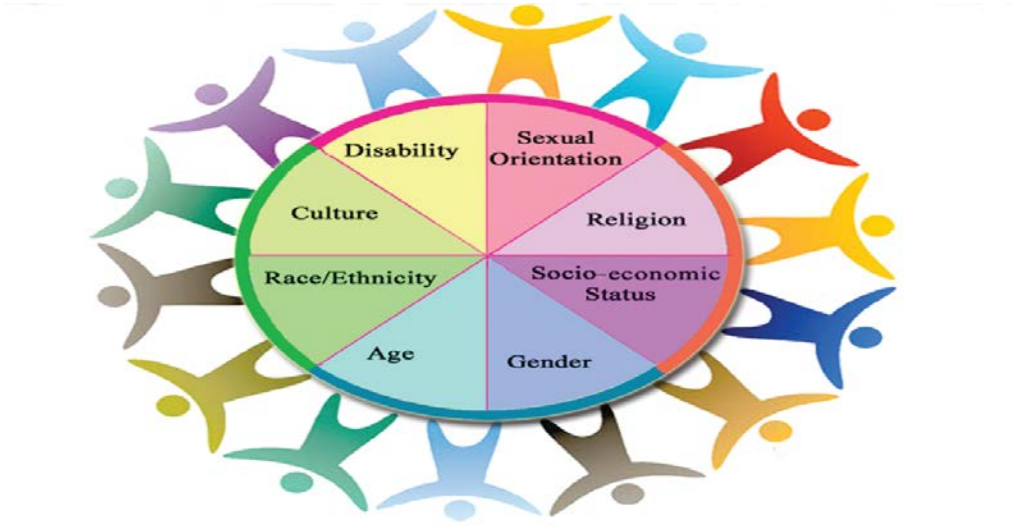
- ☐ **Legislative Committee** - Assists in organizing voter registration drives and works with the AFL-CIO, Central Labor Councils, and the APWU Auxiliary to keep the membership informed of all pending legislation and bills affecting postal workers. The committee coordinates fundraisers to solicit COPA contributions for APWU's political action fund and participate in organizing grass roots efforts to fight legislation harmful to postal employees.

- ☐ **Organizing Committee** - Has the primary job of increasing the membership in the APWU. This Committee should conduct organizing drives, highlighting the benefits of belonging, utilizing the APWU Health Plan, the Voluntary Benefits Plan, and the APWU Master Card.

- ☐ **Retirees Committee** - The Committee should notify APWU members of changes in laws affecting the Thrift Savings Plan, the Civil Service Retirement System, and the Federal Employees Retirement System. Also, should keep retired members informed of important developments on Capitol Hill which will affect postal retirees' benefits.

- ☐ **Safety and Health Committee** - Organizes co-workers to enforce their rights to a safe and healthy working environment. Concentrates on safety inspections and investigations of accidents or incidents and notifies the Postal Service of all violations.

Importance of Diversity



It is imperative that local/state unions recognize the importance of diversity when appointing committee member or when making assignments. Understanding and appreciating different points of view helps the unions tap into the varied talents and resources of all its members. Diversity involves acceptance and respect. It includes understanding that each individual is unique along the aspect of race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, socio-economic status, age, physical abilities, religious beliefs, political beliefs, or other ideologies. It is about understanding each other and moving beyond simple tolerance to embracing and celebrating the rich dimensions of diversity contained within each person.

- **Diversity Challenges** - Many individuals are unfamiliar with other cultures and have never had to learn to coexist and collaborate with individuals from completely different backgrounds. As leaders of a diverse union, it is imperative to find ways to motivate officers and committee members to work together as a team; otherwise, there will always be turmoil.

- **Diversity Benefits** - A diverse group of officers and committee members often have better ideas because of their broader backgrounds and experiences. Ethnic and cultural diversity often help unions operate better in understanding every member's interest.

- **Don't Pre-Judge and/or Stereotype** - When we make a judgment **before** getting to know someone, we **"pre-judge"** the person. When we assume everyone in a group is the same, we **"stereotype"** the individuals in the group.

- **Create a Code of Conduct** - Advise officers and committee members that the union will not tolerate discrimination of any kind. Enforce a zero-tolerance policy by taking action against anyone who violates this rule, because if you let incidents pass without comment, then other members may feel that you are silently supportive of the discrimination.



What Makes Each Person Unique - People differ in many ways:

- ***Biology***, which determines gender, body size; skin, hair, and eye color.
- ***Ethnicity and culture***, the customs, language, and sense of identity often shared by people with similar roots.
- ***Family life***, including family size, values traditions, and social class.
- ***Beliefs***, ones' religion or philosophy of life.

How to Better Understand Others

- Make a point to make friends with people different from you.
- Avoid telling ethnic or sexual jokes.
- Remember that mistakes happen, apologize, and move on.

Where to Get More Information about Our Diverse Society

- Watch plays and movies about different groups, read different magazines, and listen to different radio stations.
- Contact cultural organizations.

When you appreciate diversity, you enrich the union and your world!

Recruiting Union Activists and Volunteers



Members who are likely to become activists in the union and serve in leadership positions, including committees and stewards go beyond the "what's in it for me" syndrome and get upset when they see someone else being mistreated. Once you have recruited someone, you should work hard to keep them happy and active in the union. The following workers are normally more likely to become involved as union activists:

- ☐ **Young Workers** - These workers are the future of the labor movement and desire a change from the status quo. They bring a fresh new perspective to the organization, and have new ideas, and vitality. Don't count them out; encourage their involvement.

- ☐ **Leaders in Other Organizations** - Workers who are active in their church, PTA, the Scouts, and/or organize social events often make great activists.

- ☐ **Dissatisfied Workers** - Workers who get upset when they see the employer mismanaging the Postal Service or making poor decisions that undermines the service's relationship with postal patrons.

- ☐ **Women Workers** - Women in the union are more likely to be active if they don't feel women are treated fairly. It should be remembered that women workers are more pro-union than male workers in virtually every opinion poll taken in the last ten years.

- ☐ **People of Color** - Like women workers, people of color are more pro-union than white male workers. They are more likely to be active if they see the union as concerned with equality and social justice.

- ☐ **Workers with Issues** - Workers go to leaders with a problem and come out of that experience with either a positive or negative feeling toward the union. How we handle that problem can make a big difference, not whether the union won or lost the case.

- ☐ **Workers with Unionism in Their Background** - Many members have family members who are union activists and have already been involved in pickets and union activities. Recruiting these workers can bring a different perspective to committees.

Steps Toward Keeping Volunteers Involved



If the union wants to generate more activists and leaders for the future, it must offer programs to develop members into activists, and activists into leaders. To keep volunteers motivated and involved, follow these steps:

- ☐ **Meet Face-to-Face** - Communicating face-to-face is more effective than any other form of communication. Do not rely only on printed circulars, letters, emails, texts, and phone calls.

- ☐ **Listen** - Listening is how you get information and show your concern and establish rapport.

- ☐ **Focus on Things They Do Well** - People are more willing to begin things they know they can do. Later, when they are really a part of your group, they will be more willing to try new things.

- ☐ **Explain the Importance of the Assignment** - People work best when they know that others are depending on them.

- ☐ **Agitate** - When you agitate, you are trying, as Webster's defines the word, "to stir up people so as to produce changes. This makes people focus and encourage them to become involved. However, avoid being obnoxious.

- ☐ **Start the Work When Volunteers Arrive** - Never allow people to feel that you wasted their time, or didn't really need them. Have a variety of things to do and provide coffee and soft drinks.

- ☐ **Get Enough People to Do the Job** - Overworked people stop volunteering; therefore, have at least seven or eight people involved. Keep the schedule the same hours and days so that people can plan around it.

- ☐ **Recognize Good Work** - Thank volunteers for devoting their time and commend them on a job well done at meetings, express your appreciation and write letters of thanks.

Volunteer Application

(Submit this form to your local or state union)

Name (please print):

Address:

City, State, and Zip Code:

Home Phone:

Work Phone:

Cell Phone Number:

Work Area, Hours, and Tour:

Email Address:

I Can Help With (please check the appropriate boxes below)

☐ Canvassing	☐ One-on-One Issue Discussions
☐ Collecting Petitions	☐ Organizing Social Activities
☐ Contacting Community Groups	☐ Poll-Watching
☐ Distributing Signs	☐ Picketing
☐ Home Visits	☐ Rallies
☐ Leafleting	☐ Refreshment Committee
☐ Making Telephone Calls	☐ Transportation
☐ Working on Newsletters/Flyers	☐ Typing/Word-Processing

List Previous or Present Volunteer Jobs:

List Community Organizations You Belong to:

My Special Skills Include:

I Can Work on (please circle the appropriate boxes below)

Day of the Week	Time	Time	Time
Monday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm
Tuesday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm
Wednesday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm
Thursday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm
Friday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm
Saturday	9:00 am - 1:00 pm	1:00 pm - 5:00 pm	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm

I would like to help but am unavailable during the times listed I can work on: (List the day(s) of the week and the hours you can work.

Dealing with Difficult People



We can't change people, but we can influence them. People don't respond to techniques, they respond to values, therefore, it is important to first look at your own values in applying techniques. When dealing with difficult people it is best to begin with the END in mind. There are several different types of difficult people:

- **The Passive Communicators** - Never offer ideas or let you know where they stand.
- **The Know It-Alls** - Are arrogant and usually have an opinion on every issue. When they are proven wrong, they become defensive.
- **The Dictators** - Bullies and intimidates. They are constantly demanding and are brutally critical.
- **The 'Yes' People** - Agree to any commitment, yet rarely deliver. You can't trust them to follow through.
- **The 'No' People** - Are quick to point out why something won't work. What's worse, they're inflexible.
- **The Gripers** - Never have real grievances, but are constantly griping. They prefer complaining to finding solutions.
- **Get it Done People** - Focus on tasks. They pay attention and are detailed orientated. When under pressure, they raise their voices and are direct, and blunt.
- **Aggressive People** - Blame others for their mistakes and express anger in destructive ways. They are competitive, manipulative, create turmoil, and walk around with a chip on their shoulder.

Handling Unreasonable and Difficult People



Most of us encounter unreasonable people in our lives. We may have a difficult individual at work or at home. It's easy to let a challenging person affect us and ruin our day. Below are keys to handling unreasonable and difficult people:

- **Don't Take it Personally** - A difficult person's words can be viewed as a personal attack on others. This is not the case; their reaction and behavior are not about anyone else, it's strictly about them. Never take it personally, you end up becoming offended and react by defending your beliefs and causing additional conflict.

- **Just Walk Away** - Don't waste time by trying to change or convince a person who's unlikely to change his/her opinion. Whether it's a difficult colleague or an annoying relative, be diplomatic and interact with them only when necessary.

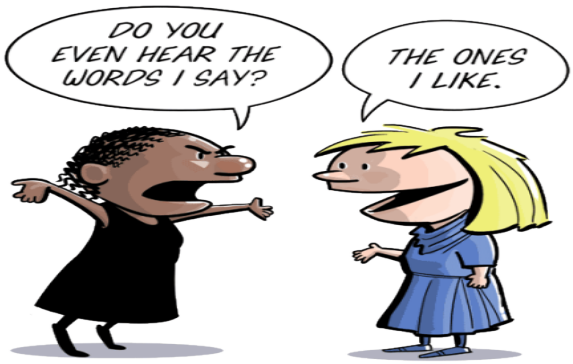
- **Be Proactive** - By avoiding personalizing other people's behaviors, we can perceive their expressions more objectively. People react the way they do because of their own issues and not because of anyone else.

- **Pick Your Battles** - You have the power to decide if a situation is serious enough to confront. Think twice, and fight the battles that are truly worth fighting. This saves time, energy, and grief and helps to avoid unnecessary problems and complications.

- **Separate the Person from the Issue** - In every communication situation, there are two elements present: The relationship you have with the person, and the issue you are discussing. Be easy on the person and stand firm on the issue.

- **Put the Focus on Them** - Most difficult people like to make others feel inadequate or uncomfortable and focus on "what done wrong," instead of "solving the problem." Avoid reacting defensively; this gives the aggressor more power. Change this dynamic by putting the focus back on the difficult person. Asking brief questions about what they expect of you neutralizes their undue influence over you.

10 Steps to Effective Listening



As a leader it is most important that you develop good communication skills. One of the most important communication skills is the ability to be a good listener. It is important to listen because you can learn more about the subject being discussed. The ten steps on effective listening aids in understanding the speaker and assist you in empathising with his/her point of view.

- ☐ **Step 1: Face the Speaker and Maintain Eye Contact** - Eye contact is considered a basic ingredient of effective communication. Put aside papers, books, the phone, and other distractions. Look at the person, even if he/she doesn't look at you.

- ☐ **Step 2: Be Attentive, but Relaxed** - Now that you've made eye contact, relax. You don't have to stare at the other person. You can look away now and then and carry on like a normal person. The important thing is to be attentive.

- ☐ **Step 3: Keep an Open Mind** - Listen without judging the other person or mentally criticizing the things they tell you. If what they say alarms you, go ahead and feel alarmed, but don't say anything negative. Listen without jumping to conclusions.

- ☐ **Step 4: Listen to the Speaker** - Concentrate on what is being said, even if it bores you. If your thoughts start to wander, immediately force yourself to refocus.

- ☐ **Step 5: Don't Interrupt** - When listening to someone talk about a problem, refrain from suggesting solutions. Most people don't want your advice anyway. If they did, they would ask for it. They prefer to figure out their own solutions and just need you to listen and help them do that. However, if you have a brilliant solution, get the speaker's permission. Ask, "Would you like to hear my ideas?"

- ☐ **Step 6: Wait for the Speaker to Pause** - When you don't understand something, of course you should ask the speaker to explain it to you. But rather than interrupt, wait until the speaker pauses.

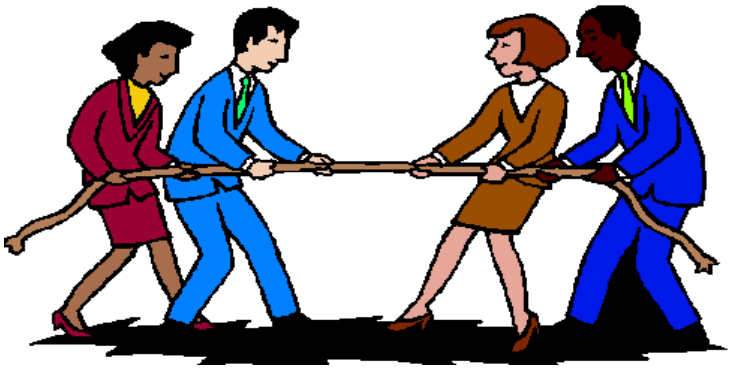
- ☐ **Step 7: Avoid Too Many Questions** - When you notice that your question has led the speaker astray, get the conversation back on track.

- ☐ **Step 8: Empathize with the Speaker** - Put yourself in the other person's place and allow yourself to feel what it is like to be them at that moment.

- ☐ **Step 9: Give Feedback** - Show that you understand where the speaker is coming from by reflecting on the speaker's feelings. "That's wonderful!" "What a terrible thing to happen to you." Give the speaker proof that you are listening.

- ☐ **Step 10: Pay Attention to Nonverbal Cues** - We learn information about each other without saying a word. Face-to-face with a person, you can detect enthusiasm, boredom, or irritation very quickly in the expression around the eyes, the set of the mouth, and the slope of the shoulders.

Resolving Conflicts



When multiple personalities interact, conflicts over opinions, principles, or conflict of interests often occur. Sometimes these differences appear trivial, but when a conflict triggers strong feelings, a deep personal need is often at the core of the problem. Following the six steps listed below will aid in conflict resolution.

- ☐ **Step 1. Cool Off** - Take a step back to gain some emotional distance before trying to talk things out. Consider some of the following: breathing deeply, splashing cold water on the face, writing in a journal, or taking a quick walk and then coming back to discuss the problem.

- ☐ **Step 2. Say What's Bothering You Using "I Messages."** - **"**I" messages are tools for expressing how we feel without attacking or blaming. A statement like, "Can't you ever complete a project?" will escalate the conflict. An "I" message comes across as, "I'm annoyed because I assigned you a project that you did not finish. What happened?" However, when making "I" statements, it's important to avoid put-downs, sarcasm, or negative body language. Be non-combative and willing to compromise.

- ☐ **Step 3. Each Restate What They Heard the Other Person Say** - Reflective listening demonstrates that we care enough to hear the other person's side.

- ☐ **Step 4. Take Responsibility** - In the majority of conflicts, both parties have some degree of responsibility. However, most of us tend to blame the other person rather than to accept our role in the conflict. If you are wrong, admit it.

- ☐ **Step 5. Brainstorm Solutions** - Come up with one that satisfies both parties. There are many solutions to a single problem. The key is a willingness to seek compromises.

- ☐ **Step 6. Forgive and Forget** - A handshake, hug, or kind word may help resolve conflict. Forgiveness is the highest form of closure. Just saying thank you, at the end of a conflict, sends a message of reconciliation.

Planning Meetings



It's the president's duty, with the help of the executive board, to plan the agenda for each membership meeting. The board should meet a week or a few days before the membership meeting and should:

- ☐ **Prepare an Agenda** - The agenda is the chair's guide for getting important things done. Plan the agenda and write down the order of events to keep from forgetting important items.

- ☐ **Handle Communications** - During the meeting, the communications to the local (letters, faxes, etc.) should be read and summarized briefly for presentation to the membership. The board should have recommendations for all letters demanding action, and include the communications in its report.

- ☐ **Read Minutes** - The executive board should read, but not change or correct, the minutes of the last meeting and include any unfinished business on the agenda and note which committees are scheduled to report.

- ☐ **Recommend Action** - The executive board can recommend actions, but the membership still makes the final decisions, unless the Constitution and Bylaws gives the executive board the authority.

- ☐ **Present Discussions to General Membership** - Business discussed by the executive board should be presented to the General Membership Meeting in the form of minutes for approval.

- ☐ **Invite a Guest Speaker** - The speaker should appeal to members' interests.

- ☐ **Post Meeting Notices** - The secretary-treasurer should post meeting notices 15 days in advance. The notice should include the type of meeting, time, date, location, and the name of the guest speaker, if applicable.

Sample Agenda for Union Meetings

If the local/state constitution and bylaws does not contain an agenda, the sample agenda listed below can be utilized.

- ☐ **Call to Order** - The chair should call the meeting to order in a timely manner except if waiting for a quorum.

- ☐ **Roll Call of Officers** - The secretary should call the roll of all officers and should note if the officer is present, absent, or excused.

- ☐ **Minutes from the Previous Executive Board and Membership Meetings** - During the General Membership Meeting, the secretary should distribute typewritten copies of minutes from the previous executive board and membership meetings. If the executive board meeting was held on the same day prior to the membership meeting, an oral report may be given. However, a typewritten copy should be available at the following executive board meeting.

- ☐ **Officers'** Reports - Officers should either give a brief oral report at the union meeting or a typewritten report to the secretary to incorporate into the record.

- ☐ **Correspondence** - The secretary should read all official correspondence to the membership that need action.

- ☐ **Old Business** - Unfinish business from the previous meeting should be discussed prior to adjournment.

- ☐ **New Business** - When the chair calls for new business, the membership may discuss items of concern.

- ☐ **Adjournment** - If there is no further business to discuss, a member can make a motion to adjourn the meeting.

SPECIAL NOTE: If one person serves as both the secretary and treasurer, he/she performs the duties listed above.

Tips for Running a Meeting



To ensure that the union meeting runs smoothly and efficiently the chair should follow the tips listed:

- ☐ **Start Promptly** - Start on time and urge officers and shop stewards to arrive on time. Introduce all officers, acknowledge first time attendees, and have them introduce themselves.

- ☐ **Make the Meeting Interesting** - Use audio-visual aids such as videos and PowerPoint Presentations.

- ☐ **Follow the Order of Business** - Normally, the order of business is part of the union's constitution and bylaws.

- ☐ **Know the Constitution and Bylaws** - Become familiar with both the local's and national's constitution and bylaws. A copy of the APWU's Constitution and Bylaws is available online at ***www.apwu.org***, click on Departments and Divisions, click on Secretary-Treasurer and scroll down to Resources, and click on APWU Constitution and Bylaws Booklet.

- ☐ **Assign Task to Committees** - Many things can be handled by committees; details should not clutter up a union meeting.

- ☐ **Vote on All Motions** - Record the results of the vote in the minutes.

- ☐ **Rotate Meeting Times** - Consider rotating the time of meetings to allow more membership participation.

- ☐ **Good & Welfare** - Discuss important issues and ways to improve the union.

- ☐ **End on Time** - Adjourn the meeting and thank members for attending.

Effective Presentations



Many people experience considerable anxiety when called upon to make a presentation to a group. While this nervousness probably cannot be completely eliminated, it is possible for each of us to improve our confidence and our competence. The listed guidelines will assist you in planning and delivering effective presentations.

- ☐ **Know Your Material** - There is no substitute for knowledge of the topic. Having the content solidly in your mind will allow you to attend to other elements of planning and delivering presentations.

- ☐ **Have a Specific Objective** - Be clear about what you plan to convey to the audience

- ☐ **Audience Analysis** - Be aware of the different points of view that may be represented in the audience and prepare your material accordingly.

- ☐ **Maintain Eye Contact** - Learning to maintain eye contact with your audience is simply an extension of our natural way of talking to people.

- ☐ **Voice Inflection and Quality** - Use brief pauses and changes in your volume, pitch, and/or rate of speech to add emphasis, focus, and interest to your presentation.

- ☐ **Utilize PowerPoint** - The use of PowerPoint can help your audience focus on what you want them to see.

- ☐ **Use Graphics** - Graphics aid in holding the audience interest.

- ☐ **Make Text Large Enough** - When giving a PowerPoint presentation, make the text large enough to see in the back of the room and limit the number of words on each screen.

Coalition Building



A coalition is an alliance of individuals or groups that join forces for a common purpose. Forming a coalition allows participants to combine their resources and become more powerful than if the individuals or groups acted alone. With the odds heavily stacked against workers, to balance the power of large corporations and level the playing field, unions need to bring allies into the struggle. Building Coalitions is an excellent tool to aid unions in rallying the public in its struggle. When building coalitions:

- **Consult with the Membership** - Ask members about their involvement in organizations in. the community. This can help identify organizations that are willing to support the union's cause.

- **Make the Connection Early** - Recruiting allies take time, particularly when you're reaching out to organizations unfamiliar with unions and what unions do. Community organizations and leaders need time to study the facts, make decisions, and mobilize their constituents.

- **Communities Are Different** - But remember, every community has organizations, political leaders, organizations, and people who care about the quality of life for working families in their communities, and who can be brought into the coalition.

- **Broaden Your Horizons** - Don't confine your list to the organizations and leaders you already know you can count on. Venture out into unfamiliar territory and you're likely to find people who are willing to help and are just waiting to be asked.

- **Support the Organization's Issues** - Understand the issues and concerns of the organizations in your community and support them. Their participation in the union's struggles can enhance their organizations' visibility; the union's involvement in their causes can enhance ours.

Potential Allies in the Community



Look around the Community --- Who is concerned about: The working poor; equal pay for women and people of color; access to health care; safe working environments; education, and retirement security? Make a list of the organizations and leaders who share the union's commitment to human and civil rights, living wages, and security for working families. Be sure to include:

- ☐ The AFL-CIO and Central Labor Councils
- ☐ Civil rights and community organizations
- ☐ Religious institutions and councils
- ☐ Elected officials, political candidates, and public figures
- ☐ Women's organizations
- ☐ Other unions and professional associations
- ☐ Seniors' and retirees' organizations
- ☐ Environmental organizations
- ☐ Students and academic organizations
- ☐ Civic organizations
- ☐ Advocacy organizations.
- ☐ Coalitions representing low-income families, tenants, consumers, etc.

Reaching out to the Community



When reaching out to an organization, start with a letter or phone call to the organization's leadership. Briefly explain the situation and tell why it's important to the organization. Request a meeting. When meeting with the organization, follow these tips:

- ☐ **The Introduction** - The union's representative should introduce himself/herself, explain his/her involvement in the union, and identify the work that the union does to guarantee health care and to improve living and working standards for families.

- ☐ **Explain the Importance of the Campaign** - Explain why the union's campaign is important, with facts about safety hazards, unfair treatment, harassment, and poor working conditions, etc. and describe how the organization can help.

- ☐ **Solicit Volunteers** - Ask for volunteers to write letters or make phone calls to elected officials during committee meetings.

- ☐ **Posting Notices** - Ask if the union can place announcements in the organization's bulletin board and/or newsletter. Find out to whom the notices should be sent.

- ☐ **Inquire about the Procedures** - Prior to speaking to an organization, discuss the appropriate dress, where to stand, the appropriate things to begin and close with, the length of time allowed, and special procedures for entering and exiting. This is especially important when addressing the religious community.

- ☐ **Addressing the Organization** - Never raise issues of controversy within the religious community, unless you are working on those issues. Do not discuss the Middle East in synagogues or abortion in churches.

- ☐ **Obtain a Commitment** - Thank the members of the organization for the meeting, and ask them to designate a liaison. Keep the liaison informed of developments in the union's campaign.

Successful Coalitions

Diverse groups can bring a variety of skills to a coalition as well as access to important target populations, such as seniors, veterans, youth, businesses, the faith community, the media, policymakers, and others.

Forming a coalition may not be easy. However, following these steps can help:

- ☐ **Recruit Participants** - Reach out to potential partners and ensure they have a voice in organizing the coalition. One of the best ways to attract people is to involve prominent members of the community who command respect and admiration from others. You may want to draft a letter inviting potential members to attend an organizing meeting and ask the community leader to sign it.

- ☐ **Get Acquainted** - Set aside time at the first meeting to get to know one another. Ask coalition members to talk about their organization, including their goals, the type of services they provide, and their expectations of the coalition.

- ☐ **Develop a Mission Statement** - A mission statement expresses the shared vision of a diverse group of people seeking a common goal. The best mission statements are short and to the point.

- ☐ **Define Goals** - Define goals that are realistic and obtainable.

- ☐ **Clarify Expectations** - Discuss the roles and responsibilities of coalition members. Include the number of times the group can expect to meet, and establish the time and location of meetings. Decide the criteria for membership.

- ☐ **Select a Project Coordinator** - Choose a project coordinator who can get the ball rolling, provide essential structure, and lead the organization's efforts. Select a person who is: respected by others, able to motivate others, knowledgeable about the issue, well organized, skilled in consensus building, a good communicator, and who recognizes the importance of diversity.

- ☐ **Get Organized** - Coalitions must be properly administered, programs must be carefully implemented, and coalition members must be inspired to continue their work.

    - Follow-up with phone calls two days prior to meetings to remind individuals to attend.
    - At meetings, decide how to achieve goals and what resources will be needed.
    - Select individuals or committees to carry out tasks.

- ☐ **Conduct Productive Meetings** - One of the best ways to maintain a coalition is to run interesting, productive meetings. To accomplish this goal:

    - Outline objectives, develop an agenda, and provide copies of the agenda.
    - Establish meeting dates, times, and locations well in advance.
    - Begin and end meetings on time and follow the agenda.
    - Encourage participation.
    - Ensure that discussions remain on topic and are not redundant.
    - When unable to agree on an item, take a vote.
    - Prepare and distribute minutes.
    - Implement the decisions made at meetings.

- ☐ **Respect Institutional Self-interest** - Each organization brings its own history, structure, agenda, values, culture, leadership, and relationships to a coalition. It is important for all members of the coalition to understand each other in order to build on their strengths and avoid unnecessary conflicts.

- ☐ **Focus on a Common Agenda** - Agree to avoid the issues on which you do not agree.

- ☐ **Provide Training for Contact with the Media** - Coalition members who will serve as spokespeople should be trained to deal with the media. Select individuals who understand the issues and speak with confidence.

- ☐ **Maintain the Coalition** - Avoid having the project coordinator do all the work. Assign activities to other coalition members and ask them to recruit others to assist. Organize committees and give responsibility for managing those committees to the chair. Ask coalition members to report on their activities at each meeting.

- ☐ **Celebrate Success** - Success is the best way to keep people involved. Celebrate victories. Host a small party or awards ceremony to recognize individuals who have played a key role.

Stress Management



Union leaders need stress to cope with emergency situations; it supplies them with the instant energy needed to complete a job or project. However, stress is dangerous when it is unduly prolonged, and occurs too often.

Stress is the body's way of coping with emotional and physical change and is a necessary part of our survival techniques and has been diagnosed by doctors as being directly related to most life-threatening diseases. Mental stress can cause anxiety, depression and can even lead to suicide; physical stress can lead to heart disease, ulcers, high blood pressure, diabetes, and alcohol and drug abuse.

What Are Stressors?

Stressors are factors which produce or cause stress. They are normally identified in three categories: social, physical and organizational.

- **Social Stressors** - Social stressors are factors either on or off the job which creates a state of resentment causing you to react such as: sexism, harassment, racism, and unemployment.

- **Physical Stressors** - Physical stressors are factors in the work environment which may affect your job performance such as poor lighting, noise, crowded working conditions, extreme temperatures, prolonged standing, unsafe working environment, chemical hazards, housekeeping problems, and/or uncomfortable chairs.

- **Organizational Stressors** - Organizational stressors are factors on the job that you have absolutely no control over such as: repetitious work, not enough responsibility on the job or too much responsibility with little or no control, excessing, and few opportunities to advance, underutilization of skills, excessive overtime, dispatches and deadlines, lack of respect by supervisors, and/or rigid rules.

Tips to Reduce Stress



People handle stress differently. If you are feeling a lot of negative stress, it's time to figure out ways to reduce your stress level. Listed below are some tips.

- ☐ **Be Organized** - Put things back where they belong so you won't go berserk looking for them.
- ☐ **Live in the Present** - The past is gone and the future will take care of itself.
- ☐ **Help Others** - Concentrate on the problems of others and yours will seem small in comparison.
- ☐ **Laugh** - Laughter distances you from problems and helps you find the proper perspective.
- ☐ **Don't Try to Change Other People** - You do your thing and allow them to do theirs.
- ☐ **Give People a Break** - Everyone has days when they need the people around them to be especially patient and tolerant.
- ☐ **Practice Using Different Words** - Instead of referring to something as a problem, call it a challenge or an opportunity.
- ☐ **Don't Allow Others to Make You Angry** - Choose to react in a calm manner.
- ☐ **Learn to Say "No"** - When requests and invitations become a burden, it is time to say **"no."**
- ☐ **Save Money and Live within Your Means** - Having an emergency "nest egg" makes you less stressed.

Alleviating Stress



Unfortunately, we will never have a completely stress-free environment or society, and following these 10 Steps will not eliminate stress; however, by practicing them in your everyday lifestyle and work environment you will better learn to cope with its effects:

Joyce's 10 Steps to Alleviating Stress	
Step 1. Value Yourself	You are somebody. Respect your abilities and forgive your errors.
Step 2. Limit Projects	Stop trying to accomplish everything. Finish one task before starting another.
Step 3. Delegate Authority	No one person can do it all. Utilize others who are willing to help.
Step 4. Think Positively	Avoid relationships with negative thinking people.
Step 5. Confide in A Friend	Talk to someone you trust about your problems.
Step 6. Don't Procrastinate	Don't put off the task until the last minute.
Step 7. Select a Hobby	Try reading, gardening, swimming, exercising, or playing tennis.
Step 8. Learn to Compromise	Find alternative solutions to handling incidents; stop arguing or fighting.
Step 9. See Your Doctor Regularly	Assuring that you are in good health aids in stress reduction.
Step 10. Know When to Walk Away	Avoid prolonged bad relationships and friendships